NowAI decision memo

As of 6 November 2026. Numbers come from `AI_Company_Model.xlsx` as saved on 6 November 2026 at 11:37, from `NowAI_Fact_Sheet.md`, and from `research/Latest_1B_Companies.md`. Where the workbook covers a number, the workbook wins.

Where NowAI stands today

- NowAI has no customers, no pilots, no interviews and no revenue.
- No accountant, practice, dealer or agency has been contacted. The founder will send all outreach themselves.
- No agent is built. Any demo must say it uses made-up data.
- No money has been raised. The 1,500,000 AZN starting cash in the model (about USD 0.9M at 1.7 AZN per USD, the founder's rate, not checked) is the founder's plan.
- Every NowAI number in this memo is a model result, a target or an estimate. None is a measurement.

Labels and terms

Label	Meaning
verified	Official source, or two reputable outlets
reported	One outlet
estimate	Our judgement. "Estimate, no data" means the workbook calls it an assumption, so nothing stands behind it yet
model	Arithmetic on stated inputs, in the workbook unless marked
target	A goal or the founder's plan, not a result
unknown	Not found

Terms used below, each explained once.

Term	Meaning
Practice	An accounting practice or outsourcer that keeps books for many small firms
Client company	A small firm served by a practice. NowAI charges per client company
ARR	Annual recurring revenue. One month of subscription revenue times 12
Agent	A piece of software that does one narrow job and waits for a person to approve the result
1C	The accounting software most accountant job ads ask for
e-qaimə	The state e-invoice. Sentence start: E-qaimə
ƏDV deposit account	A tax-service account that holds the VAT on invoiced purchases
EMAS	The Ministry of Labour platform where labour contracts are signed electronically
ASAN İmza	The electronic signature accountants use to file with the tax service
Reconcile	Match each bank line to the document that explains it
Churn	The share of paying practices that leave each month
Gross margin	Revenue minus the direct cost of serving a client, as a share of revenue
Break-even	The number of practices at which revenue covers all costs
Money flow	Payments and credit that pass through a business. Selling inside that flow earns a share of each payment
Strategic sale	Selling the company to a larger software or finance group
The skeptic	The independent review of 5 November 2026 that tried to break the top ideas using 10 web lookups. Where it and the first draft disagree, the skeptic wins

Prices are AZN a month before VAT unless stated. VAT is the 18% sales tax.

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1. The decision and what we recommend

The decision. Whether to start NowAI as the AI back office for Azerbaijani small firms, sold through the accounting practices they already use. The first step is a 90-day test.

Our recommendation (judgement). Go, in gated steps.

1. Spend the first 90 days on interviews, a real test set, a narrow first build and ten pilot practices.
2. Build nothing before 20 practices have been interviewed.

3. Stay at the core team of 5 until practices pay.
4. Stop the Books product if fewer than 3 of 10 pilot practices pay.
5. Commit to the larger plan only after the day-90 gates in section 11 are met.

Why go.

- The door is real. Accountants are the buyer or the channel at Pennylane, Basis and Rillet. On the stricter reading of Azerbaijani rules, a certified person must approve the work, which fits a design where the accountant approves every entry.
- The test is cheap compared with the plan. It answers the question nobody has asked yet: do practices pay?

Why only in gated steps.

- On Azerbaijani subscriptions alone, the Base case runs out of cash around month 45. It shows no operating profit within 60 months (model).
- Base ARR at month 36 is 741,364 AZN, about USD 436,097 (model).
- The realistic Azerbaijan ceiling is USD 2,353,002 a year, 2.4% of the $1B target (model).

The honest outcome range.

- $1B is a stretch. It needs roughly 180,000 to 330,000 paying firms across several countries, with money flow (section 10). Omie has about 180,000 clients after about 12 years.
- A strategic sale is the likely good outcome. At the price Visma paid per client for Conta Azul, NowAI would be worth about USD 7.4M at 2,477 client companies and about USD 72M at 24,000 (model).

Founder decisions still open are listed in section 13.

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2. The opportunity

The market

Measure	Value	Label	Date
Active SMEs	424,437	verified	2024
Micro / small / medium	410,913 / 9,737 / 3,787	reported	2024
Micro share	96.8%, so about 97%	model	2024
Legal-person SMEs / individual entrepreneurs	48,363 / 376,074	reported	2024
Active VAT payers	62,414	reported	1 Oct 2026
SME share of value added / of employees	18.5% / 45.3%	verified	2024
Average wage	1,172 AZN a month	verified	June 2026
Accounting practices and freelance accountants	Not found. This is the key gap	unknown	Nov 2026
Audit bodies	226 (157 organisations and 69 independents). Research says they are not the SME bookkeeping channel	reported	end-2023

Why a practice is the buyer

- Only the heads of micro and small firms and individual entrepreneurs may keep their own books. Other firms need an accountant or an outsourcer (reported, 2026).
- Chief accountants must be certified under the stricter of two readings of the rule, which a lawyer must still confirm. So a certified human has to approve the work. NowAI cannot be the signing accountant.
- One sale to a practice brings many client companies. A 30-client practice pays 435 AZN a month (model).
- Selling to small firms one by one does not pay. At the Light price of 5 AZN, gross profit is about 2.58 AZN a month (model). That cannot cover a field sale.
- Only 3,787 medium firms exist, so "medium firms only" runs out of buyers.

Why not banks

Banks already run their own AI tools and have their own teams for this work. They are few, slow to buy and need long security reviews (estimate). This is the founder's decision, and the earlier bank direction is closed.

What small firms struggle with

The full ranking is in research/SME_Pain_Points.md. Three points matter here.

6. **Survey evidence does not show bookkeeping as a top pain.** In the World Bank Enterprise Survey 2024, tax rates are the most-named biggest obstacle: 16.5% of 368 firms (reported). On a separate question, 81% of

firms call tax rates "no obstacle" (reported, microdata). Bookkeeping and regulation do not appear as obstacles.

7. **The case rests on how SMEs buy and on yearly rule changes.** Four things changed in January 2026: POS sales counted at 0.5, a 6% POS rate, e-invoice timing and income tax on staff (verified). Interviews must confirm that this creates paid work.
8. **Late payment between firms has no Azerbaijani data.** It ranks last of 12 pains on our scoring. This matters for NowAI Cash (section 5).

The white space

We found no product on sale that does the whole job for accounting practices. Several local products do parts of it. The real competitor is the cheap human accountant. Even this is a search result, and a missing search hit does not prove a missing product.

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3. What the newest $1B companies teach

Source: research/Latest_1B_Companies.md, checked 6 November 2026. All company figures below come from that file. It also lists figures we left out because the sources were weak. This memo does not use them.

The market. 195 companies joined the Crunchbase Unicorn Board in the first half of 2026, against 193 in all of 2025 (verified). The US had 110 of them.

The newest class

Company	What it does	First $1B	Latest value	Revenue	Sold to or through
Rillet	AI accounting system for finance teams	Aug 2026	$1B	Not disclosed. 600+ customers	Direct, plus accounting firms as partners
Basis	AI agents for accounting firms	Feb 2026	$1.15B	Not disclosed	Accounting firms only
Avoca	AI call agents for plumbers and heating firms	Apr 2026	$1B	Not disclosed. 800+ customers	Direct to owners
Slash	Business banking for niche sellers	Apr 2026	$1.4B	$250M annualised, CEO-stated	Direct, one niche at a time
Wonderful	Customer-service agents in 35+ markets	Mar 2026	$5B, Sep 2026	Not confirmed	Direct, with deployment engineers
Serval	AI IT service desk	Dec 2025	$3B, Oct 2026	Not disclosed	Direct to companies
Tide	Business accounts for micro firms	Sep 2025	$1.5B	Not confirmed	Direct and partners
Lovable	Builds apps from text	Jul 2025	$13.3B, Aug 2026	$400M+, Feb 2026	Self-serve

Closest to NowAI: accountants as the channel

Company	Country	Value	Clients	Note
Pennylane	France	About $4.25B, Jan 2026	About 800,000 firms through about 6,000 accounting partners	About EUR 115M a year in 2025. French e-invoicing helped
Basis	US	$1.15B, Feb 2026	About 30% of the top 25 US firms (company claim)	About $138M raised. Sells only to accounting firms
Rillet	US	$1B, Aug 2026	600+	More than $200M raised
DataSnipper	Netherlands	$1B, Feb 2024	All Big Four	About 130 staff at $1B. A plug-in inside Excel
Omie	Brazil	About $700M before the 2025 round	About 180,000	About R$600M a year. Founded about 2013. Now adding banking, credit and payments
Conta Azul	Brazil	About $300M sale to Visma, Aug 2025	About 100,000	Software fees only. Price undisclosed by the company
Paraşüt	Türkiye	Sold in 2019, price undisclosed	11,000+	Now part of the Mikro group
Clear	India	$700M+, 2021	Not found	No new priced round since. Losses and layoffs reported

Warnings

- **Bench** (Canada) sold human bookkeeping with software. It shut down without notice on 27 December 2024 and was bought by Employer.com. The company never stated a reason. Our reading is that AI must cut labour per client.
- **Pilot** (US) reached $1.2B in March 2021 and has had no priced round since.
- **Basis** shows that a high price can come with no disclosed revenue. That is a warning for how we present NowAI.

What the winners share, and what it means for NowAI

Lesson from the newest class	What NowAI does about it
One narrow job for one clear buyer	Version one is document intake and bank reconciliation, sold to practices
Accountants are the buyer or channel in rich countries. In emerging markets, software sold that way stopped short: Omie at about $700M after about 12 years, Conta Azul sold for about $300M	Books is the door. It cannot be the whole company
A legal push helps. Pennylane had French e-invoicing	Azerbaijan changes its rules every January. We treat that as a sales trigger
From a home market under about 40 million people, every company at $1B owned the money flow (Uzum, Kaspi, Tabby) or sold globally early (Insider, Picsart). We found no exception	NowAI Cash and the regional play (section 5)
The smaller the customer, the more money flow matters	See the revenue-per-customer table below
Agents need people. DataSnipper is the smallest back-office company at $1B, at about 130 staff	Plan 5 to 12 people until the product is proven. Expect more than 100 before $1B
Investors price speed, and most of these companies disclose no revenue	We show our own numbers and say they are untested

Revenue per customer a year, USD. Counter-evidence exists: Vanta and Avoca passed $1B with no money layer, but their customers pay far more per task.

Company	Revenue per customer	Money layer
Vanta	About 18,750	No
Gusto (cash collected, not ARR)	About 2,000	Partly
Melio	About 1,900	Yes
Qonto	About 950	Yes
Omie	About 600	Adding one
NowAI at launch price (model)	About 100	No

Money-layer evidence. Toast earned about 82% of 2025 revenue from fintech and 15% from subscriptions (verified). Xero bought Melio for $2.5B upfront (verified). We found no Azerbaijani company at or near $1B. That rests on a few searches, so it is not proof.

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4. The ideas tested and their verdicts

The founder raised 10 ideas. We tested each against the companies that reached $1B most recently and the ones that came close and stopped.

#	Idea	Verdict	Evidence	Effect on $1B
1	SMEs, not banks	Keep	Strong	Medium. SMEs only work through a channel, and only with more revenue per client than a subscription gives
2	Many agents, like Wonderful	Keep as the destination. Start with one agent	Strong	Large, later. Every recent winner started with one job
3	Bookkeeping	Keep as the first product	Strong	The door. It does not reach $1B alone
4	Regulatory framework	Keep as a feature and a reason to buy	Medium	Small alone, large as a moat. Clear is the weak record. Vanta worked because customers pay about $19,000 a year
5	Certification	Keep for later	Weak	Small. We found no company at $1B on small-firm certification
6	HR issues	Keep as a later product	Medium	Medium. No public way for software to connect to EMAS. It needs Books running first
7	Cash flow and taking payments	Move up to second, after Books	Strong globally, weak locally	The largest
8	A builder agent, in the style of Sierra's Ghostwriter	Use the format now. Build it for our own use from about month 12. Do not sell it	Medium	Medium, for entering new countries. Unproven
9	10 to 15 people	Right to start, wrong to finish	Strong	A limit on the finish. It adds no value
10	$1B from Azerbaijan	Not from Azerbaijan alone	Strong	Decides the route

How the 18 scored ideas map (estimate). Books has 2, Cash 3, Tax 3, People 3, Comply 4, and 3 are routes to market with no agent of their own. The skeptic stress-tested only the top three. A high score on the others is not proof.

Best idea score for each agent, of 5 (estimate).

Agent	Score	Note
NowAI Books	3.90	Survived the skeptic with four fixes (section 5)
NowAI Cash	3.90	The score comes only from two ideas, Loan-Ready and Receivables Copilot. The skeptic failed both
NowAI Tax	3.30	The state pre-fills the simplified-tax declaration. AI cannot lower tax rates
NowAI People	3.40	No EMAS API found. Payroll is mostly a rules engine
NowAI Comply	3.45	Cash-register part has fine data. Licences and certificates have no cost or time data

Product order, at the founder's decision: Books, then Cash, then Tax, then People, then Comply. The founder should confirm it, because the workbook's price path depends on it.

Rule of three. Build Tax, People and Comply only when three paying practices ask. Cash is the one exception. It moved up on evidence from other countries, so it sits ahead of any local demand signal.

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5. The three strongest businesses

Why these three

Business	What it is	Why it is on the list	Evidence
1. Accountant Autopilot (NowAI Books)	AI prepares checked entries for practices	The only product a practice can buy first. Everything else sits on its data	Strong on channel, none yet on willingness to pay
2. NowAI Cash, on top of Books	Who owes whom, reminders, cash forecast, payments through a licensed partner	The idea that changes the maths for $1B	Strong globally, weakest locally
3. The regional rules-and-rails play	The same product in nearby countries, with a new rule pack for each	The only route that can reach scale	Thin. Our inference, unproven

Why not a different three.

- NowAI Tax is a module inside business 1. The state pre-fills the simplified-tax declaration, and AI cannot touch tax rates, the part firms complain about.
- NowAI People has no public EMAS connection, so it can only prepare data for manual entry. Payroll is mostly a rules engine already inside 1C, Bitax and Complex.az. Formalising staff raises owners' costs, which limits demand.
- NowAI Comply includes certificates and licences, the weakest area. Only its cash-register part has hard fine data.
- All three are sold to the same practices and share the same core, so they stay as modules inside business 1 until three practices ask.
- If the first 90 days show that Cash fails its two gates, the better three become Books, the regional play and Tax or People, whichever practices ask for first.

Business 1: Accountant Autopilot (agent name NowAI Books)

Customer. The owner of an accounting practice. Later, in-house chief accountants at small and medium firms (about 150 AZN a month, estimate, no data).

Product. AI would read each client's invoices, receipts and bank statements. It would prepare checked entries for 1C or similar software, reconcile the bank, match e-qaimə and keep each client's filing calendar. The accountant would approve every entry and files under their own signature. NowAI never holds a client's ASAN İmza.

First build. Narrower. The skeptic limits version one to document intake and bank reconciliation, sold as an add-on to 1C. E-qaimə matching and the filing calendar follow.

How the client sees it (a hypothesis to test).

- The owner photographs a receipt and sends it to one WhatsApp number in the practice's name.
- NowAI would read it and put it in the accountant's queue. If a page is missing, it would ask the client in Azerbaijani or Russian.
- The client never signs, files or approves anything there.
- We do not know how clients send documents today, whether practices will let software message their clients, or whether sending financial documents through a foreign messaging service fits the data rules. All 20 interviews will ask.

What makes it different. It is a workflow for the practice that joins seven steps into one job:

9. Take mixed photos, scans and PDFs in Azerbaijani and Russian from many clients.
10. Prepare checked entries for 1C or similar software.
11. Reconcile the bank.
12. Match e-qaimə.
13. Keep each client's filing calendar.
14. Put every entry in front of the accountant.
15. Charge per client company.

Each step exists somewhere. We found nobody joining them for practices. The gap is in the workflow, and the technology exists. The gap is narrow and unprotected. A written rules library, authored by a certified accountant, is the moat we would build.

Price. Per client company: Light 5, Standard 15, Heavy 60 AZN a month. Blended 14.50 AZN (section 7).

Value to a practice (model, nothing timed). In the Base case a 30-client practice saves 102.5 hours a month. That is worth 1,046 AZN on labour and 1,234 AZN on capacity, against a 435 AZN bill.

Expansion. 1C dealers sell it from month 13 (target). Tax, People and Comply follow when three practices ask.

First demo. A scripted demo on made-up data exists (see `demo/Demo_Guide.md`). It says so on screen and proves nothing about accuracy or willingness to pay.

What would kill it. Fewer than 3 of 10 pilot practices pay.

Business 2: NowAI Cash, built on Books

Customer. The owner or finance manager of a B2B seller, reached through the practice.

Product. Who owes you, whom you owe, reminders, a cash forecast, and collecting and paying through a licensed partner. NowAI never holds the money. The forecast must show VAT held in the ƏDV deposit account, or it overstates cash (estimate). Epoint and Payriff are the candidate partners. Neither has been contacted.

Why it is second.

- Every company we found from a home market under about 40 million people that passed $1B owned the money flow or sold globally early.
- Omie, the closest company to NowAI, is adding banking, credit and payments.
- Xero paid $2.5B for Melio, a bill-payment company.

What it earns (all inputs are estimates with no data, and partner fees are not published).

Line, AZN a month per client	Value
Books at the launch price	14.50
Modules, Base year 3	8.48
Receipts through payment links (150,000 AZN of yearly sales x 15% through links x 0.4% share of the fee)	7.50
Supplier payments (bills at 70% of sales x 15% paid through NowAI x 0.1%)	1.31
Invoice-finance referrals (3% of clients x 20,000 AZN x 1%)	0.50
Money layer	9.31
Total revenue per client	**32.29**
Gap to Omie's revenue per client	53.57

Azerbaijan alone does not close that gap. Other countries and larger clients have to.

What it is worth to one example client (model). A firm with 600,000 AZN of credit sales a year collects 15 days sooner. That frees 24,658 AZN. At 18.6%, the average rate on new manat loans in June 2026, it saves 4,586 AZN a year. One month of that saving is 12.7 times the 30 AZN reminder module. The 15 days is an estimate with no data.

The honest weaknesses.

- Local evidence is the weakest of all 12 pains: rank 12, score 9. We found no Azerbaijani survey or statistic on late payment between firms.
- The skeptic failed Receivables Copilot until 30 firms are measured.
- The Base price path rests on this module. All 3.00 AZN of year-2 module revenue and 6.00 of the 8.48 AZN in year 3 come from reminders. If they do not sell, Base runs out of cash in month 42 and needs 460,185 AZN within 60 months (test on a copy).
- NowAI would earn only a share of a partner's fee, far less than Kaspi or Uzum earn with their own banks.
- Holding or moving client money needs a Central Bank licence. Links through a licensed partner look workable, but that is our reasoning and no ruling has been given.
- Invoice-finance referrals rest on paid-intermediary rules nobody has read.

Two gates before building.

Gate	Proof	Kill
Overdue invoices measured at 30 firms (distributors, wholesalers, building suppliers)	The typical firm has 20% or more of receivables over 30 days late	Overdue is under 10% in most firms, or owners refuse reminders to their buyers
Written answer from the Central Bank or a lawyer on payment links through a licensed partner	Yes: a software firm may work through a licensed partner without holding money	The answer is no, or partner terms leave no margin

A kill on either gate stops Cash. Books continues.

Business 3: the regional rules-and-rails play

The idea. Azerbaijan, Georgia, Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan run on an accountant, 1C and a mandatory or phased e-invoice. So a new country may need a new rule pack and not a new product. This is our inference and it is unproven. Türkiye is contested and runs on Logo, Mikro and Paraşüt.

What ports and what does not (estimate). The document engine ports. Posting rules and e-invoice formats are rebuilt for each country. An internal builder tool, from about month 12, would set up clients and draft a new country's rules. It is for our own use and is not for sale. It is unproven.

Draft order: Georgia, Uzbekistan, Kazakhstan, with Türkiye last (estimate).

	Kazakhstan	Uzbekistan	Georgia	Türkiye
SMEs	About 2.18M operating, 1 Jan 2026 (verified)	1,236,126 operating small-business subjects, 1 Jul 2026, including sole traders and farms (verified)	About 921,500 active enterprises, 2023 (reported). Looks high for about 3.7M people, so an upper limit	3,936,542, 2024 (reported)
Competition found	No AI-bookkeeping data found. Kaspi bundles SME tools in its app (reported)	A state AI tax service. No private AI bookkeeping start-up found	No AI-native bookkeeping start-up found	Paraşüt has an AI module. Logo, Robom and Sovos are active. Already contested
Accountant channel	Outsourced accountants and 1C partners. Size not found	Outsourcing exists. Size not found	SMEs file themselves on rs.ge more often (not measured)	Licensed accountants file for most SMEs. Closest analogue, and contested

These counts use different definitions. Do not add them into one market size. The workbook adds them only to test what share $1B would need (section 10).

Higher-price markets: the UAE and Saudi Arabia.

- Bookkeeping costs 15 to 70 times more there (reported, accountant marketing pages).
- Saudi Arabia is the strongest pull and the hardest entry. E-invoicing is compulsory in waves. Arabic is required on invoices, and the data-protection law restricts moving personal data out of the Kingdom.
- The UAE e-invoicing system runs through government-accredited providers. Dates conflict between sources, so they must be checked with the Ministry of Finance.
- Wafeq, Qoyod, Daftra and Zoho Books are ahead. OCTA and Oncount are AI start-ups already in the region. Wafeq raised about $10.5M in total (reported).
- A Baku team would need native Arabic, a local licensed partner, a certified e-invoicing provider or white-label route, probably local hosting, and local sales.
- Our view: a plausible few million dollars a year. It does not reach $1B on its own (estimate). The best route is to sell to Gulf accounting firms as an AI layer on top of the incumbents, which needs a Dubai entity, a local co-founder and a design-partner firm.

Why it is third. It depends on businesses 1 and 2 working. The evidence is thin, and every country has its own surprise. Uzbekistan has a state AI tax service, Georgian SMEs file for themselves, Kaspi sits in Kazakhstan, and Türkiye is crowded. The workbook's illustration puts three countries at year 5, with 800 practices, 24,000 client companies, 40 people and USD 10,000,000 of capital (target, not raised).

Why software and not a service

The workbook models only the software case: a monthly fee per client company. It does not model a consultancy or a managed service. We chose software because both warnings come from human-heavy models. Bench kept about 650 staff and shut down. Pilot's done-for-you model reached $1.2B in 2021, and no new round followed. In the workbook, hands-on onboarding needs 40 people at 400 practices, against 17 with a standardised process and 10 with self-serve (launch price, model). Service creep is the Bench trap, so onboarding stays standardised.

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6. Competition

The correct claim. "We found no product on sale that does this whole job for accounting practices. Several local products do parts of it. The real competitor is the cheap human accountant." Prices and AI features are mostly unknown.

Competitor	What it does	Threat
Audit and outsourcing firms (Crowe ABAK, RSM) and freelance bookkeepers	Human outsourced accounting. Fees not public. Freelancers ask about 100 AZN a month (estimate, thin)	**High.** The cheap human accountant caps what a practice pays for a tool
AI One Docs	Reads scanned invoices and turns fields into data. No public price	**Medium-high.** The only local product found doing the same first step. No visible accountant workflow, 1C posting or e-qaimə matching
Bitax	Local cloud accounting. 14-day trial, no AZN price shown	Medium. Closest cloud rival for small firms. No AI or e-invoice feature found
Complex.az	Local cloud ERP, 50-2,000 AZN a month (vendor-affiliated source). Claims an AI module, unverified	Medium. Aimed at mid-size firms
GW Audit, GW Accounting	Platform from an audit firm, in development	Medium. Could bundle it with its own accounting service
1C connectors for e-qaimə (including Best Soft add-ons)	Upload and download e-qaimə already work	Medium. Rivals already hold the plumbing
AZ Smart	Accounting ERP with a mobile cash-sales module (skeptic's finding, no product page found since)	Medium until checked
1C through local dealers	The dominant platform in accountant job ads	Low as a rival. High as a gate, because NowAI must write entries into it
State tools (e-taxes cabinet, e-qaimə, e-mühasibat)	Free portals that file and submit statements. They do not book entries	Low as a substitute. Medium as a dependency, because the state controls data access
Bank business apps	Payments and balances. No invoicing or accounting features found	Low today. Medium-term risk if a bank bundles accounting
Viasoft, VAT Portal, SINAM	ERP, e-invoice bridge, government integrator	Low to medium, and Viasoft says AI should not post on its own, which supports our design
Regional and global	Wafeq, Qoyod, Daftra, Zoho Books, OCTA, Oncount in the Gulf. Basis and Rillet in the US	None in Azerbaijan today. They set the bar and could enter

What worries us most.

- Rivals could copy the first step in one release.
- The state could ship a free tool that books entries for practices.
- 1C dealers are our planned channel and they also sell e-qaimə add-ons. They could become rivals.

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7. Pricing

The tiers (target, set by the founder, untested)

Tier	Who	Price per client company, AZN a month	Document limit a month	Typical documents (estimate, no data)
Light	Simplified-tax micro client	5	50	25
Standard	VAT-paying small client	15	200	100
Heavy	Larger client	60	1,000	500

Blended price: 14.50 AZN per client (model). It assumes a mix of 50% Light, 40% Standard and 10% Heavy (estimate, no data). A 30-client practice is 15 Light, 12 Standard and 3 Heavy clients, and pays 435 AZN a month.

What local prices say

Anchor	Price	Label
SINAM SESDA Connect	20 AZN per user a month, VAT included	reported
Freelance bookkeeper	About 100 AZN a month. Other listings show 150 and 350 with no period	estimate, thin
Complex.az	50-2,000 AZN a month	reported, vendor-affiliated
Chamber of Auditors fee floor	4,000 AZN a year, about 333 a month	reported, 2019
Published outsourced bookkeeping prices in Baku	None. Firms quote on request	unknown

The realistic band is 10-100 AZN a month for micro and small firms, and a few hundred for medium firms (estimate).

Is the price worth it to a practice?

We test value against a screen of 2.5 times the price (a house rule of thumb, carried over, not checked). "Labour" means hours saved, priced at what the accountant costs. "Capacity" means freed hours resold to new clients at the practice's own fee.

One 30-client practice, launch price	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Monthly bill, AZN	435	435	435
Hours saved a month	46.1	102.5	199.9
Labour value, AZN a month	470	1,046	2,039
Capacity value, AZN a month	272	1,234	3,540
Value / price on labour	1.08x	2.40x	4.69x
Value / price on capacity	0.63x	2.84x	8.14x
Share of all client hours saved (proof bar 30%)	14.6%	27.9%	42.6%
Bill as a share of the practice's fee income (6,600 AZN)	6.6%	6.6%	6.6%
Verdict	Fails both	Passes only on capacity	Passes on labour alone

What this means.

16. Value is thin. Base passes only on capacity, which is a sales promise that counts only if the practice finds new clients. Labour value is not cash unless the practice avoids a hire or sells the hours.
17. The launch price sits just above what labour supports. The highest blended price that passes on labour in Base is 13.94 AZN, under the 14.50 launch price.
18. The labour verdict flips at accountant pay of 1,248 AZN. The input is 1,200 AZN, built on undated ads, net or gross unknown. At 1,400 AZN Base passes on labour alone (2.80x).
19. Only the Heavy client passes on labour in Base. Conservative fails both at every client type.
20. If every client pays the practice only the Light fee of 100 AZN, the bill is 14.5% of fee income.

Price path in the model

Revenue per client, AZN a month	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Conservative	14.50	16.00	17.50
Base	14.50	17.50	22.98
Optimistic	14.50	21.48	30.93

These are assumptions built from draft module prices. No module beyond Books exists.

Module	Agent	Draft price per eligible client, AZN	Eligible share	Take-up, Base year 2 / year 3
E-invoice matching	Books	20.00	50%	0% / 0%
Tax checks	Tax	10.00	50%	0% / 10%
Payroll and EMAS	People	12.50	50%	0% / 10%
Receivables reminders	Cash	30.00	50%	20% / 40%
Cash-register checks	Comply	30.00	90%	0% / 5%

Take-up rates are estimates with no data. Nobody has been asked. E-invoice matching is inside Books at launch, so it is not sold twice.

The price rises 58% from year 1 to year 3 in Base, but the value counted does not rise. At the year-3 price, value / price falls to 1.52x on labour and 1.79x on capacity. Modules would have to add about 22.59 AZN of value per client a month to pass on labour. Nobody has measured that.

Other price facts

- **Per client or per firm?** The only price hint for this product is a flat 50-150 AZN a month per firm (estimate). At 30 clients that is a third of the 435 AZN bill or less. At those prices gross margin is negative and break-even shows "Never". At 150 AZN the price per client (5.00 AZN) is below direct cost (5.72 AZN).
- **VAT.** NowAI passes the 200,000 AZN limit in Base in month 23 and must then add 18%. A 30-client practice has 79,200 AZN of turnover, so it probably cannot reclaim VAT. Base then falls to 2.04x on labour and 2.40x on capacity, which is "Fails both". If the market price must include VAT, NowAI keeps 12.29 AZN of 14.50.
- **Free first month.** Each pilot starts with one free month. Practices brought by 1C dealers skip it, because dealers would sell a paid subscription (estimate).
- **Dealers.** A dealer keeps 20% of revenue on practices it brings (estimate, no data). No dealer has been asked.
- **In-house accountants** at small and medium firms would pay about 150 AZN a month (estimate, no data). A Heavy client with the same documents pays 60 AZN through a practice.

Unit economics per client (model)

Line, AZN a month	Launch price	Year-3 target
Revenue	14.50	22.98
Direct cost	5.72	6.56
Gross margin	60.6%	71.4%
Contribution, no dealer	7.33	14.11
Contribution with the dealer share	5.96	11.94

Direct cost at launch is 4.36 AZN of documents, 0.36 AZN of WhatsApp messages, 1.00 AZN of cloud and storage, and 0 AZN of connector fees. Connector fees are 0 because no quote exists, so every margin here is before that cost. Hosting also has no quote. Support for one practice costs 61.20 AZN a month with standardised onboarding, about 14% of a 435 AZN bill.

Tier	Gross margin at typical use	Gross margin at the document limit
Light	51.5%	30.3%
Standard	62.6%	34.3%
Heavy	62.3%	26.9%

Reading cost is the biggest cost risk. The model assumes USD 0.01 a page, untested on Azerbaijani documents.

Reading cost, USD a page	Gross margin at launch	Break-even practices at launch, team of 12
0.01 (model input)	60.6%	364
0.03 (Azure custom extraction)	24.5%	1,267
0.05 (third-party figure for custom extraction)	-11.5%	Never

A separate build estimate, which sends easy documents to a cheaper AI model, puts the cost near USD 0.014 per document. The workbook uses about USD 0.025 and wins. The two must be reconciled before any blueprint is shown.

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8. A 12-person organisation, and how it is built

The team

The model starts with a core of 5 people at 5,500 AZN a month loaded cost each (the founder's figure, estimate). Support people sit on top of the core at 2,142 AZN loaded (pay of 1,800 AZN, founder to confirm). In the model, each 12,000 AZN of monthly revenue pays for one hire above the core, up to a ceiling of 12. A team of 12 costs 80,000 AZN a month once other fixed costs of 10,000 AZN and fixed sales and marketing of 4,000 AZN are added. A team of 6 costs 47,000 AZN.

The roles below are our proposal. The counts and costs come from the workbook. The roles come from the backend research.

#	Role	Owns	When
1	Founder and chief executive	Product, sales, partners, legal and regulator contacts	Start (core)
2	Technical lead	Architecture, ledger, audit trail, security, hosting, the hiring bar	Start (core)
3	Evals and AI engineer	The test set, accuracy per language, prompt and model changes, cost per document	Start (core)
4	Backend and integrations engineer	Intake, agent engine, 1C import files, bank parsers, e-qaimə files	Start (core)
5	Chartered accountant, domain lead	The rules library, chart-of-accounts templates, what may be auto-approved	Start (core)
6	Second backend engineer	Model router, workflow engine, approval queue	Hire 6
7	Front-end engineer	Accountant web app and approval screens	Hire 7
8	Product and design	Accountant workflow, WhatsApp conversation design, pricing tests	Hire 8
9	Sales and partnerships lead	Practices, 1C dealers, onboarding, incident handling	Hire 9
10	Implementation accountant	Sets up clients, collects corrections, feeds the test set	As practices grow (support)
11	Second implementation accountant	Same	As practices grow (support)
12	Integrations engineer	The 1C connector, bank APIs, WhatsApp provider, payment partner	By month 12

One part-time contractor for infrastructure and security sits outside the 12.

What the model says about size at month 36. Headcount is 6 in Conservative, 10 in Base and 12 in Optimistic. Support people needed are 0.77, 2.60 and 5.61.

How many practices can the team serve? One support person has 140 productive hours a month. At 4 hours per practice (standardised onboarding) that is about 35 practices. With hands-on onboarding at 12 hours it is about 12. These are arithmetic on model inputs, and the hours are estimates with no data.

The design in one view

Layer	What it does	Rule we follow
Front doors	WhatsApp for clients, a web app for the accountant	The client learns no new tool
Intake	Saves the original, checks for duplicates and blur, queues the job	Reading is tested on 200+ real local receipts before launch
Agent brain	Books first. Cash, Tax, People later. One shared engine	A narrow job per agent
Knowledge	Client memory, a written rules library, a supplier map	Rules are human-written and versioned, so they can be audited
Records	Ledger, document store, audit trail	Corrections are reversing entries. Every proposal is logged
Approval queue	Every proposed entry waits for the accountant	Nothing is posted or sent without a click
Outside systems	1C, e-qaimə, banks, payment partner	Files first. No public state API was found
Foundation	Hosting, keys, monitoring, test suite	Test set before agents. Agents never hold keys

Other points.

- **Files first.** NowAI plans to work through 1C import files, bank statement files and e-qaimə exports. A small connector beside the accountant's 1C is planned from month 12.
- **Hosting is undecided.** No rule found requires servers in Azerbaijan. The reading and model costs in the workbook are foreign cloud prices. We need one in-country quote, then a design.
- **Data law needs a lawyer.** Foreign cloud and WhatsApp may count as moving personal data across a border.
- **Risk we name.** Accuracy on real Azerbaijani and Russian receipts is unmeasured. No benchmark exists for any reading tool. If accuracy is poor, accountant time per document erases the saving.

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9. The model at 5, 15, 30, 60 and 100 paying practices

Here a "customer" is a paying practice. All figures are model results. None has been tested with a practice.

The three scenarios

Input	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Meetings with practices a month	8	12	16
First month a pilot can run	6	4	3
Meetings that become pilots	15%	25%	35%
Pilots that become paying practices (60% is the research pass bar and is no forecast)	40%	60%	70%
Monthly churn	3%	2%	1%
Client companies per practice	20	30	50
Practices added through 1C dealers a month, from month 13	1	2	4
In-house companies added a month, from month 13	0	2	0
Minutes per document by hand / share removed after approval	3 / 30%	4 / 50%	6 / 65%
Starting cash, AZN	1,500,000	1,500,000	1,500,000

All inputs are estimates with no data. Conservative keeps the list price and a 40% pilot conversion to test cash only, although that case fails the value screen. A real conservative outcome means a lower price or fewer practices than shown.

Table A: steady-state profit at each size (Startup P&L)

One year at full size. It ignores churn, free months and payment timing. It uses 30 client companies per practice, which is the Base input. The workbook does not run this table for 20 or 50 clients per practice, so **steady-state profit at these sizes for Conservative and Optimistic is not in the workbook.** The three delivery modes are hands-on onboarding, standardised onboarding and self-serve.

At the launch price of 14.50 AZN. Cells show headcount / annual profit in AZN.

Paying practices	Client companies	Revenue a year	Hands-on	Standardised	Self-serve
5	150	26,100	6 / -510,504	6 / -510,504	6 / -510,504
15	450	78,300	7 / -509,808	6 / -484,104	6 / -484,104
30	900	156,600	8 / -495,912	6 / -444,504	6 / -444,504
60	1,800	313,200	11 / -493,824	7 / -391,008	6 / -365,304
100	3,000	522,000	14 / -465,335	8 / -311,111	7 / -285,407
200	6,000	1,044,000	23 / -432,671	11 / -124,223	8 / -47,111
400	12,000	2,088,000	40 / -341,638	17 / 249,554	10 / 429,482

At the year-3 target of 22.98 AZN.

Paying practices	Client companies	Revenue a year	Hands-on	Standardised	Self-serve
5	150	41,355	6 / -498,300	6 / -498,300	6 / -498,300
15	450	124,065	7 / -473,196	6 / -447,492	6 / -447,492
30	900	248,130	8 / -422,688	6 / -371,280	6 / -371,280
60	1,800	496,260	11 / -347,376	7 / -244,560	6 / -218,856
100	3,000	827,100	14 / -221,255	8 / -67,031	7 / -41,327
200	6,000	1,654,200	23 / 55,489	11 / 363,937	8 / 441,049
400	12,000	3,308,400	40 / 634,682	17 / 1,225,874	10 / 1,405,802

The rows for 200 and 400 are in the workbook and show where profit begins.

Break-even (fixed cost per month divided by what each client leaves after direct cost and sales cost):

Team	Fixed cost a month, AZN	Break-even practices, launch price	Break-even practices, year-3 price
6 people	47,000	214	112
9 people	63,500	289	150
12 people	80,000	364	189

With the dealer share, a team of 12 needs 448 practices at launch and 224 at the year-3 price. A team that pays for its own support needs 267 practices at launch and 119 at year 3. There is no public count of practices, so none of these can be checked against the market. The only count is 226 audit bodies, which research says is not the SME channel. Break-even at launch is 1.61 times that count.

Table B: when each scenario reaches each size (Cash calc monthly rows)

The workbook has no summary table by size for the three scenarios. We read the first month in which each scenario's paying practices reach the size, from the monthly rows on the Cash calc sheet. Prices differ by month (year 1, 2 or 3 prices apply), so this table is not comparable with Table A. ARR includes in-house companies in Base from month 13. Cash is the balance at the end of that month.

Size	Scenario	Month reached	Practices that month	ARR, AZN	Headcount	Operating profit that month, AZN	Cash, AZN
5	Conservative	14	5.4	20,852	6	-42,979	900,427
5	Base	7	5.3	27,628	6	-42,992	1,201,058
5	Optimistic	5	7.8	67,867	6	-42,382	1,282,056
15	Conservative	23	16.0	61,274	6	-41,663	513,622
15	Base	13	17.0	110,465	6	-39,189	945,450
15	Optimistic	7	15.4	134,383	6	-39,579	1,195,960
30	Conservative	41	30.0	126,182	6	-39,300	-220,713
30	Base	17	30.4	208,789	6	-35,210	790,549
30	Optimistic	11	30.3	263,472	6	-34,139	1,040,557
60	Conservative	Not reached in 60 months. Peak is 38.5 practices					
60	Base	28	62.2	564,173	8	-26,166	413,758
60	Optimistic	16	63.8	821,720	10	-26,093	844,197
100	Conservative	Not reached in 60 months. Peak is 38.5 practices					
100	Base	46	101.2	926,144	11	-20,016	-37,140
100	Optimistic	22	106.4	1,370,823	12	-7,690	684,955

How to read it.

- Base reaches 100 practices in month 46, after its cash has already run out in month 45.
- Optimistic reaches 100 practices in month 22. It is still at an operating loss of 7,690 AZN that month with the revenue-step hires. On core and support only it makes 8,810 AZN.
- Conservative never reaches 60 practices in 60 months.
- Nothing in the model caps the funnel at the number of practices that exist, because nobody knows it. Optimistic wins about 225 practices gross over 36 months, which is 99.7% of the 226 audit bodies counted.

Table C: results at the usual horizons

Result	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
Paying practices after 12 / 24 / 36 / 60 months	2.7 / 17.0 / 26.9 / 38.5	13.4 / 51.4 / 81.3 / 123.0	33.9 / 120.0 / 196.4 / 324.0
Client companies after 12 / 24 / 36 months	53 / 339 / 537	403 / 1,565 / 2,477	1,695 / 6,002 / 9,819
ARR after 12 months, AZN	9,300	70,112	294,941
ARR after 24 months, AZN	65,119	362,846	1,546,622
ARR after 36 months, AZN	112,854	741,364	3,643,801
ARR after 36 months, USD	66,385	436,097	2,143,412
ARR after 60 months, AZN	161,780	1,129,474	6,012,434
Revenue in year 3, AZN	95,030	619,904	3,008,664
Operating profit in year 3, AZN	-484,469	-312,690	966,348
Headcount after 36 months	6	10	12
First profitable month	Not in 60 months	Not in 60 months	25
Cash at month 36, AZN	-21,070	197,454	1,457,420
Month cash runs out	**36**	**45**	**Not in 60 months**
Extra funding needed within 60 months, AZN	981,472	313,736	0
Share of practices brought by dealers, month 36	64.3%	47.3%	43.7%

Notes.

- Base cash at month 36 is 197,454 AZN, about 7.1 months of cash at that month's burn.
- The Base funding figure of 313,736 AZN is not the full need. Cash is still falling at month 60, so the gap keeps growing.
- Base does not reach an operating profit within 60 months, even with core and support only.
- The funnel needs 432 meetings over 36 months in Base. Only 33 prospects are named, and many are not practices.
- Optimistic is the only funded case. It assumes 50 clients per practice and a 70% pilot conversion, and nobody has been asked.

Four tests on the Base case (run on a copy, not stored in the workbook)

Test	Cash at month 36, AZN	Month cash runs out	Funding within 60 months, AZN	First profitable month
Base as modelled	197,454	45	313,736	Not in 60 months
Client mix 70 / 25 / 5	158,911	43	395,058	Not in 60 months
Support at 5,500 AZN loaded, not 2,142	-668	36	817,436	Not in 60 months
E-invoice matching sold as a module at 100% take-up	301,121	Not in 60 months	0	50 (35 on core and support only)
Reminders do not sell	157,195	42	460,185	Not in 60 months

The fourth row matters most. It shows that one choice, whether e-invoice matching is a paid module or stays inside Books, changes the Base outcome more than any other input tested. That is a founder decision.

At an 80 / 18 / 2 mix, the blended price is 7.90 AZN and break-even is 719 practices.

What is not in the workbook. Revenue and profit for a consultancy or a managed service at these sizes. Steady-state profit for 20 and 50 clients per practice. A cap on the number of practices. A quote for hosting or connector fees. A fresh independent audit: the earlier audit found 8 blocking issues, all 8 were fixed, and the builder's own check found no errors, but no second reader has gone over the rebuilt workbook.

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10. What $1B would take, and the route

This is arithmetic. It is no forecast.

The sum

$1B at 10 times revenue needs USD 100,000,000 of ARR, which is 170,000,000 AZN a year. Omie was valued at about 6 times its reported revenue, so 10 times is not cautious.

Revenue per client, AZN a month	Client companies needed at 10x	At 5x	At 25x
14.50 (launch)	977,012	1,954,023	390,805
22.98 (year 3)	616,613	1,233,225	246,645
80 (what-if)	177,084	354,167	70,834
200 (what-if)	70,834	141,667	28,334

The same answer from what buyers paid per client. Conta Azul's buyer valued it at about USD 3,000 a client, Omie at about USD 3,889 and Pennylane at about USD 5,313 (all reported). At those prices $1B takes 333,334, 257,143 and 188,236 clients. So $1B means roughly 180,000 to 330,000 paying firms.

Azerbaijan is the proving ground

Pool at 10x	Count	Share needed at 14.50 AZN	At 22.98 AZN
Azerbaijan VAT payers	62,414	1,565%	988%
Azerbaijan legal-person SMEs	48,363	2,020%	1,275%
Azerbaijan all active SMEs	424,437	230%	145%
Kazakhstan operating SMEs	2,180,000	45%	28%
Uzbekistan operating small businesses	1,236,126	79%	50%
Georgia active enterprises (upper limit)	921,500	106%	67%
Türkiye SMEs	3,936,542	25%	16%
All five countries	8,698,605	11.2%	7.1%

Over 100% means the pool is too small.

Azerbaijan ceiling (legal-person SMEs x 22.98 AZN x 12 x share won)	Share won	Revenue a year, USD	Value at 10x, USD	Share of the $1B target
Realistic	30% (estimate, no data)	2,353,002	23,530,022	2.4%
Full coverage	100%	7,843,341	78,433,406	7.8%

The 376,074 individual entrepreneurs sit outside this ceiling.

Money flow moves the ceiling, but not far. With 100 AZN more revenue per client a year, the realistic Azerbaijan ceiling is USD 3,206,467. With 300 AZN more, it is USD 4,913,396. At a 1% referral fee, 300 AZN a year means one 30,000 AZN loan per client each year. The paid-intermediary rules are unread.

The workbook's illustration of what would have to happen

Steps 1 and 2 read the Base case. Steps 3 to 5 are what you would need to believe (target). All steps assume 30 clients per practice. Team and capital on steps 3 to 5 are assumptions, and capital is planned and has not been raised.

Step	By when	Paying practices	Client firms	Revenue per client, AZN a month	Annual revenue, USD	Value at 10x, USD	Value at Conta Azul's price per client, USD	Tea m	Capital by then, USD
0. Prove it: Azerbaijan	First 90 days	3	90	0	0	0	270,000	3	882,353
1. Books live: Azerbaijan	Year 1	13	403	14.50	41,242	412,421	1,208,820	5	882,353
2. Azerbaijan leader, Cash added	Year 3	81	2,477	24.95	436,097	4,360,966	7,429,789	10	882,353
3. Three countries, money flow live	Year 5	800	24,000	35.00	5,929,412	59,294,118	72,000,000	40	10,000,000
4. Region: five countries	Year 7	3,000	90,000	50.00	31,764,706	317,647,059	270,000,000	120	50,000,000
5. $1B	Year 10	6,000	180,000	80.00	101,647,059	1,016,470,588	540,000,000	250	150,000,000

Step 2's 24.95 AZN is above the 22.98 AZN list price because it includes in-house companies at 150 AZN.

Conditions for $1B

Each step has a gate. All gates are targets, and none has been met.

Step	What must be proven to climb
0	Reading accuracy on 200+ real receipts. 30% of client hours saved. Three practices agree to pay. Overdue invoices measured at 30 firms. A written legal answer on payments
1	Practices renew after the free month. Entries are approved with few edits
2	Cash adds revenue in real clients. New funding is found, because the Base case runs out of cash without it
3	A licensed payment partner is live. A second country reaches the same accuracy in under 6 months. The internal builder cuts set-up time
4	Money flow earns as much as subscriptions. Local teams work without hand-holding from Baku
5	About Pennylane's number of partner firms, Omie's revenue per client and Omie's client count

Other conditions.

21. **New money, early.** On Azerbaijani subscriptions alone Base cash runs out in month 45, before the illustration reaches three countries in year 5. New funding is a condition of step 2. It would have to arrive on the strength of about 81 practices and USD 436,097 of ARR at month 36.
22. **A bigger company than 12 people.** The illustration has 250 people at step 5. The smallest back-office company found at $1B had about 130.

23. **More capital than Azerbaijan holds.** The plan needs USD 10,000,000 by year 5 and USD 150,000,000 by year 10. Start-ups in Azerbaijan raised about USD 2.6M across 22 companies in 2025 (reported). The 1,500,000 AZN start is about a third of that, so a foreign investor is needed. The Azerbaijan ceiling of USD 2,353,002 a year may be small for them.
24. **Revenue per client of 80 AZN.** Azerbaijan reaches 32.29 AZN even with the assumed money layer.
25. **The legal route for payments is yes, and partner terms leave a margin.**
26. **The rails really are shared.** This is our inference, and the evidence for it is thin.

The three routes, honestly

Route	What it needs	Our view
1. Regional money flow	180,000+ paying firms across several countries, with money flow	The main route to $1B. A long shot
2. Higher-price markets (UAE, Saudi Arabia)	Native Arabic, a certified e-invoicing provider, a local licensed partner, probably local hosting. Wafeq, Qoyod, Zoho and OCTA are ahead	A plausible few million dollars a year. Not a route to $1B on its own (estimate)
3. Strategic sale	A working product and a base of client firms	The most likely good outcome. Visma and Xero have paid for this kind of company. At Conta Azul's price per client, about USD 7.4M at 2,477 clients, or about USD 72M at 24,000 (model)

A sale at USD 7M to USD 72M would still be a very good result for a founder in Baku.

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11. The 90-day plan

Nothing below has started, and no start date is set. The founder sends all outreach themselves.

The kill test is one question: do practices pay? Time saved is measured, but it no longer decides.

Days	Work	Output
1-30	**First step: interview 20 practices.** Add 10 in-house accountants. Nothing gets built before these interviews	Real answers to the questions below
1-30	Talk to a 1C dealer (Best Soft first) about import formats and resale terms	1C route known, dealer terms known
1-30	Ask the State Tax Service, VAT Portal, the labour ministry and the ASAN İmza and SİMA operator about integrator access	A file or API route known
1-30	One legal session on data terms, before any client document arrives	Processor terms and consent wording
1-30	Collect one anonymised month of documents from 5 practices, with client consent	A real test set
1-60	Measure overdue invoices at 30 B2B firms. Get aged-receivables reports and record the share overdue and days late	First Azerbaijani data on late payment
1-60	Get a written answer from the Central Bank or a lawyer on payment links through a licensed partner, with NowAI never holding money	Legal route for NowAI Cash: yes or no
31-60	Build the test set first. Then build only intake for the 5 most common document types, a 1C import file, bank reconciliation and an approval screen	First version
31-60	Test reading on 200+ real local receipts. Time documents by hand and with the tool	Reading accuracy, cost per page, minutes per document
61-90	Pilot with 10 practices: one free month, then the tier prices. Ask each to sign a paid order for month 2 before the free month starts	Signed orders by day 90
91-120	First invoices fall due	Cash paid, the final read of the kill test

A fix to the plan, for the founder to confirm. The earlier plan said "paid pilot in days 61-90, after a free first month". The free month fills those days, so no payment can be seen by day 90. So we read signed orders on day 90, and cash paid by about day 120.

What the interviews must settle.

- How many clients a practice serves, and the mix of Light, Standard and Heavy clients.
- What it charges each type, what it pays an accountant (net and gross), and the hours and minutes per document.
- Which software it uses, and how clients send documents today.
- Whether it would pay per client or a flat fee per firm, and how much.
- Whether it is VAT-registered, and whether it would share one anonymised month of documents.
- Whether its clients sell on credit, and which job it would want next: cash, tax, payroll or compliance.

What the answers change in the workbook: clients per practice, client mix, fee per client, accountant pay, minutes per document, reading cost, and price per client or per firm. We do not replace those inputs without that data.

Named prospects. 33 are named from public information, and none has been contacted. Many are not practices, and their size is mostly unknown. They include outsourcing and audit firms, 1C dealers and integrators, professional accountant associations and training centres. Base needs 432 meetings in 36 months, so the list must grow.

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12. Risks and kill tests

Proof and kill tests (all targets, none measured)

Test	Proof	Kill	Note
Do practices pay?	6 of 10 pilot practices pay	Fewer than 3 of 10 pay	3 to 5: do not scale. Fix price or scope and test again (our judgement)
Will practices share documents?	5 practices give one anonymised month	Practices refuse	Without documents there is no product
Time per client	30% less, timed before and after, on all client hours	Warning under 15%, not a stop on its own	The model says Base saves 27.9% and Conservative 14.6%
Entry quality	90% or more of entries accepted unchanged	None set	Time and quality explain the pay result
Contracted scale	300+ client companies under contract	None set	6 practices at 30 clients is only 180
Reading	Accuracy measured on 200+ real receipts	None set	Decides the reading-cost input
Overdue invoices (gate for Cash)	The typical firm has 20% or more of receivables over 30 days late	Overdue is under 10% in most firms, or owners refuse reminders	A kill stops Cash, not Books. It also removes the Base price path
Payment route (gate for Cash)	Written answer that a software firm may work through a licensed partner without holding money	The answer is no	A kill stops the money layer, not Books

Three practices that agree to pay clear the kill line but miss the 6 of 10 proof. Step 0 of the illustration asks only for three.

The main risks

Risk	Why it matters	What would prove us wrong
Practices will not pay	No evidence either way	Fewer than 3 of 10 pilot practices pay
The price model is wrong	The only hint is a flat 50-150 AZN per firm, and the model shows "Never" at that price	Practices insist on a flat fee in that range
Too few practices	Break-even needs 189 to 448 practices for a team of 12, and the count is unknown	Azerbaijan has fewer practices than break-even needs
Clients are mostly tiny	Light clients have few documents and may keep their own books. The state pre-fills their declaration	Practices report a mix near 80 / 18 / 2
The cheap human accountant	A freelance bookkeeper near 100 AZN a month caps what a practice pays	Practices near 100 AZN a client refuse any per-client fee
Reading fails on local documents	No accuracy data exists. Thermal print and mixed languages add noise	Accuracy is low, or custom reading at USD 0.03-0.05 a page is needed
Time saved is too small	Base saves 27.9% of client hours, under the 30% bar. Approval takes time	Timed tests come in near or under 15%

Risk	Why it matters	What would prove us wrong
1C as a gate	NowAI must write into 1C. Dealers already sell e-qaimə connectors	Dealers refuse, or 1C import proves unworkable
Copying	Vendors can copy the first step in a release	A rival ships the same workflow at a lower price
The state moves in	The state controls data access and is rebuilding e-mühasibat	A free state tool books entries for practices
Data trust and law	Practices must hand over client documents. Duties on personal data and tax secrecy are unclear	Practices refuse, or a lawyer says the design must change
Costs not yet quoted	Connector fees are 0 and hosting has no quote	Quotes push margin well under 60.6%
Service creep (the Bench trap)	Hands-on onboarding needs 40 people at 400 practices, against 17 standardised	Support hours stay near 12 a practice instead of 4
Funding	Base runs out of cash in month 45. Local start-up money is thin	Pilots show no route to a better price or mix
Cash has no local pain	No Azerbaijani data on late payment exists	Overdue is small at the 30 firms
No legal route for payments	The money layer depends on a licensed partner and a written answer	The answer is no, or partner terms leave no margin
Small ceiling	The realistic Azerbaijan ceiling is USD 2,353,002 a year	Investors will not back a regional path

Where the evidence and the plan pull against each other

27. The product order changed late. The workbook saved at 11:37 on 6 November puts Cash second. We follow the workbook, because its prices depend on that order, and the founder should confirm it.
28. Cash moved up on global evidence, while local evidence for it is the weakest of all 12 pains. The Base price path now rests on a module the skeptic failed.
29. Survey evidence does not show bookkeeping as a top pain. The plan rests on how SMEs buy and on yearly rule changes, and interviews have not confirmed either.
30. Saved time is worth little where an accountant costs about 10.20 AZN an hour (model). Books sells mainly saved time.
31. The proof bar of 30% of client hours is above what the model expects in Base (27.9%).
32. Base assumes 30 clients per practice. Pennylane has about 133 SMEs per accounting firm (800,000 divided by 6,000, and some of those SMEs may have come directly). One sale here brings fewer clients at a far lower price.
33. Software sold through accountants stopped short of $1B in emerging markets. That is the closest evidence we have, and it argues against the software-only case.
34. The Base price rises 58% in two years on take-up rates that nobody has tested. Tax and People wait for three paying practices, yet the model books their revenue in year 3.
35. The 90 days hold 20 interviews, 10 in-house interviews, 30 firm measurements, a legal answer, a dealer talk, state enquiries, a 200-receipt test, a build and 10 pilots, with a start team of 3 on the illustration. The plan is full.
36. The plan needs real client documents by day 30, from practices that must trust a start-up with no product and no track record. Refusal is a kill condition, so the first hard step is also the weakest.

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13. What is unknown

Ranked.

37. Do practices pay, how much, and per client or per firm? Nobody has been asked.
38. How many accounting practices and freelance accountants exist? How many certified accountants, and members of the two professional accountant associations?
39. Clients per practice, client mix, fee per client and hours per client.
40. Reading accuracy and true cost on real Azerbaijani and Russian receipts.
41. Late B2B payments: the share overdue and days late. Nothing Azerbaijani exists. The text of the ƏDV deposit decisions is unread.
42. The payment route: a written answer on links through a licensed partner, partner fees and the payment-agent rules.
43. The 1C route: import format, dealer terms, 1C's share among accountants, and any document recognition in the Azerbaijani configuration.

44. Official API or integrator status for e-qaimə, e-taxes and EMAS, and bank statement formats beyond one bank's contract API.
45. Data law: the 2024 amendments, the new draft, any registration duty, tax secrecy, and client documents passing through foreign services.
46. Accounting law: the two-certified-accountants rule for outsourcers, the scope of the chief-accountant certificate, and whether software may prepare filings.
47. Hosting and connector costs. No quote exists.
48. Features and prices of Bitax, Complex.az, AI One Docs, Best Soft, Viasoft, GW Accounting and AZ Smart.
49. Accountant pay in 2025-2026, net or gross, from dated ads.
50. Whether the AHK and SMB Agency AI platform announced in June 2025 ever launched.
51. For the region: Georgia's 2025 count, Kazakhstan's AI competitors, Uzbekistan's SME e-invoice dates, accountant counts everywhere, and whether the same rails hold in practice.
52. Company facts we have not verified: Pennylane's founding and total raised, why Bench failed, Paraşüt's price and buyer, and the revenue of Basis and Rillet.

Must be checked with a lawyer.

53. Which chief accountants must hold a certificate, and whether a micro firm's accounts need one's signature.
54. What software may prepare, and how the e-representative route works when a practice uses NowAI.
55. Who is liable for a wrong entry or wrong tax answer, and what the contract with a practice must say.
56. Whether NowAI is a data processor, and whether reading documents on foreign cloud or sending them through WhatsApp needs consent.
57. NowAI's own VAT position, and whether practices can reclaim the VAT.
58. For later agents: payment links through a licensed partner, and liability for drafting labour contracts.

Founder decisions still open.

59. Confirm the product order: Books, Cash, Tax, People, Comply.
60. Does e-invoice matching stay inside Books, or become a paid module? One test on a copy says this alone stops Base running out of cash.
61. Are the module prices and take-up rates right?
62. Is support pay of 1,800 AZN right?
63. What is the hosting design, after one in-country quote?
64. Direct first with dealers in month 13, or dealers first as the skeptic says? Dealers would also cut contribution from 0.61 to 0.41 per AZN of revenue.
65. Confirm the fix to the free month and the pay test (section 11).

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14. Sources

- `NowAI_Fact_Sheet.md`, 6 November 2026. The single source of truth for this pack.
- `AI_Company_Model.xlsx`, saved 6 November 2026 at 11:37. Sheets read: Results, Startup P&L, Practice ROI, Cash model, Cash calc, Path to $1B and Unicorn math.
- research/Latest_1B_Companies.md, for every company figure.
- `NowAI_Idea_Assessment.md`, for the ideas and verdicts.
- research/SME_Pain_Points.md, for what small firms struggle with.
- Backend research, for the design and the team roles. Research on higher-price markets, for the UAE and Saudi Arabia.
- The skeptic's review of 5 November 2026, as recorded in the fact sheet.